an extended hardening period not only for code but also for the features themselves. By focusing on just the data from their project management system and ignoring the data they were collecting from their beta and how it affected the project, they ended up hurting their consumer when all they wanted was to deliver more efficiently.

In this example the team narrowed their focus to where they thought the problem was instead of looking at the big picture. They ignored the beta feedback as a data point in their lifecycle and looked only at data from their immediate team. To avoid this problem the team could have acknowledged that the beta cycle was a critical part of delivery and figured out how to measure its value before cutting it.

As you dig into the data, make sure you do your analysis with an open mind instead of manipulating the data to fit your hypothesis.

9.2. Different publishing methods

Every organization has different quirks around their methods of communication. Wherever you work there are probably different emails, dashboards, and reports that different people rely on for information. The best way to communicate across an organization is to communicate within the boundaries of that organization. If everyone expects to see a status report every Tuesday, then maybe piggy-backing on that report is a great idea. If everyone sends those emails straight to their deleted folder, then maybe using a dashboard where people can pull data when they need it will work better. Following are some tips on using dashboards, emails, and reports; you know what works best in your organization so you should take what works best and apply it.

9.2.1. Building dashboards

We’ve been using dashboards throughout this book. Web-based dashboards are a great way to publish results so anyone in your company can check out the data when they want. The following sections provide some dashboarding tips.